

EAM310 · EAM DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM · SUMMER 2026

Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference — Palpation & Inquiry, Week 7

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Week 7 · Diagnosis by Palpation & Inquiry · Summer 2026
TCM for Ballroom Dancers | Dance Medicine Specialty

Read this before Quiz 5/6. Every answer is here.

Highest-yield facts only — for last-minute review, not first-pass learning.

1 Palpation — Core Techniques & Logic

THREE TECHNIQUES?

Palpation (tracing, hands/feet→elbows/knees) · Pressing (thumb/fingertip, 3x increasing pressure) · Feeling (temp/moisture/texture).

PRESSING LOGIC?

Tenderness/pain = Excess · more pain = accumulated xie qi · weak/soft (± tenderness) = Qi stagnation · slippery/hard = Phlegm.

SKIN TEMP: COLD VS HOT?

Cold = Cold pattern. Hot on 1st touch, cools w/ pressure = Ext. Wind-Heat. Hot on medium not heavy pressure = Int. Heat (MB/Heart). Hot on heavy pressure near bone = Empty-Heat from Yin def.

DORSAL VS PALM HOT?

Hot dorsal = Full Heat. Hot palm = Empty Heat. (Ling Shu 74)

XU LI (APICAL BEAT)?

Clear/slow=normal · feeble=Zong Qi def · strong/hard=Excess Lung/Heart · large-but-empty=Heart-Qi def · stop-start=shock/poor prognosis · rapid=shock/fright/anger.

2 Abdominal & Point Palpation

NAN JING 5-PHASE ABDOMINAL MAP?

Above navel (Ren 12-15)=Heart/Fire · at navel=Spleen/Earth · below navel (Ren7-Pubis)=Kidney/Water · R side under ribs=Lung/Metal · L side under ribs=Liver/Wood. Cite Nan Jing/Shang Han Lun, not Su Wen.

FUKU SHIN KEY FIGURES?

Sugiyama (1610-94) · Todo Yoshimasu (1702-73) · Inaba Bunrei & Yoshitora Wakuda — 19th c.

NORMAL ABDOMEN?

Solid-not-hard, resilient-not-tight, elastic-not-soft. Hard+pain-worse-w/-pressure=Full. Too-soft+ache-relieved=Empty. Soft/flabby lower abd=Yuan Qi def. Fixed masses=Blood stasis.

FRONT-MU VS BACK-SHU?

Front-Mu = front/yin surface, sensitive as qi collects/accumulates. Back-Shu = on Bladder channel on the back, roughly level with the organ, strong for tonify/sedate.

AE TREATMENT POINTS?

BL 13, 14, 15, 18, 20, 23. Toxic qi in the Ke (control) cycle between yin organs — Su Wen 65.

MASTER TUNG PALM MAP?

Index→LU10=Lung · Middle→PC8=Heart · Ring→wrist=Liver&Spleen. Colors: blue/black=pain · light blue=cold+def · dark blue=pain+excess · red=heat · yellow+atrophy=def · very dark/gloomy=pathogen at Interior.

3 Inquiry Framework

10 VS 16 QUESTIONS?

Maciocia's 10: chills/fever, sweating, head/body, 2 excretions, diet, chest/abdomen, hearing, thirst/drink, previous illness, cause of illness. Schrier's 16 adds: Pain, Emotions, Sexual Symptoms, Energy Level as new categories, restructured into 16 headings.

16 QUESTIONS IN ORDER?

1 Pain · 2 Food/Taste · 3 Stools/Urine · 4 Thirst/Drink · 5 Energy · 6 Head/Face/Body · 7 Chest/Abdomen · 8 Limbs · 9 Sleep · 10 Sweating · 11 Ears/Eyes · 12 Cold/Heat/Fever · 13 Emotional · 14 Sexual · 15 Women's · 16 Children's.

GOLDEN RULE OF ASKING?

Every question should confirm or exclude a pattern — never recite the 16 as a rote script; always ask yourself why.

4 Q1 Pain

3 MECHANISMS OF PAIN (NEIJING)?

1. Circulation impeded (Su Wen 39) · 2. Tension (Su Wen 39/62, Ling Shu 10) · 3. Lack of nourishment (vessels don't moisten sinews/bones).

FULL VS EMPTY PAIN?

Full: aggravated by food/BM/vomiting/pressure, relieved by rest, sharp character, worse w/ movement. Empty: alleviated by food/BM/rest/pressure, dull character, better w/ movement.

PAIN CHARACTER KEY?

Distending/moving=Qi stagnation · boring/stabbing fixed=Blood stasis · cramping+cold=Cold · burning+fullness=Heat · intense+fullness=food retention.

BI SYNDROME 5 TYPES?

Wandering=Wind · Painful=Cold · Fixed=Damp · Heat=Heat (sudden, swelling/redness) · Bone=chronic progression of the other 4.

5 Q2-4 Food, Taste, Stools, Urine, Thirst

APPETITE?

Lack=SP-Qi def · excessive=ST-Heat · fullness=Dampness/food retention · distention=Qi stagnation.

TASTE MAP?

Bitter=Liver/Heart Heat · sweet=SP def or Damp-Heat · sour=food retention or LR invading ST · salty=KD-Yin def · pungent=LU-Heat.

STOOLS — QUICK MARKERS?

Better after BM=Full · worse after BM=Empty (constipation context differs, see Study Guide) · undigested food=SP-Qi def · black/dark=Blood stasis · alternating constip/diarrhea=stagnant LR-Qi invading SP.

URINE COLOR?

Pale=Cold · dark=Heat · turbid/cloudy=Dampness.

URINE PAIN TIMING?

Before=Qi stagnation Lower Burner · during=Damp-Heat Bladder · after=Qi deficiency.

THIRST?

Cold drinks desired=Heat · warm drinks desired=Cold · no thirst=Cold/no Heat · thirst but no desire to drink=Damp-Heat or Yin def.

6 Q5, Q9, Q10 Energy, Sleep, Sweating

TIREDFNESS MAP?

AM worse=SP/ST-Yang def · weak voice=LU-Qi/Yang def · feeling cold=KD-Yang def · heaviness=Dampness · muzy+dzzy=Phlegm · distention+irritable+Wiry=LR-Qi stagnation.

SLEEP PHYSIOLOGY?

Depends on Blood/Yin of HT & LR; SP also influences. Mind/Shen & Hun need anchoring by HT/LR Blood.

INSOMNIA TYPES?

Can't fall/stay asleep=Blood def not anchoring Shen/Hun (Empty). Restless+heat+dreaming=pathogens agitating Shen/Hun out of Blood (Full). Wake many times=Yin def w/ Empty Heat. Wake early=GB deficiency.

Not Tested

Categories of Dreams / Neijing dream chapters (Su Wen 17, 80; Ling Shu 43) are explicitly marked not tested.

SWEAT LOCATION?

Head only=ST Heat/Damp-Heat · whole body=LU-Qi def · palms/soles/chest=Yin def (5-palm heat) · day=Yang def · night=Yin def.

7 Q6 Head, Face, Body

Headache Location	Channel	Cause
Nape	Tai Yang	Ext. Wind-Cold or KD def
Forehead	Yang Ming	ST-Heat or Blood def
Temples/sides	Shao Yang	Ext. Wind or LR/GB Fire rising
Vertex	Jue Yin	LR-Blood def
Whole head	—	Ext. Wind-Cold

HEADACHE TIMING?

Daytime=Qi/Yang def · evening=Blood/Yin def · night=Blood stasis.

HEADACHE QUALITY?

Heavy=Damp/Phlegm · distending/throbbing=LR-Yang rising · boring/nail-like=Blood stasis · empty+relieved by pressure=KD def.

FACE: COLD SORES/ULCERS?

Cold sores → ST channel (Full-Heat/Empty-Heat/Qi def). Tongue-tip ulcers=HT-Fire. Ulcers in pregnancy=Ren Mai disharmony.

NUMBNESS: BILATERAL VS UNILATERAL?

Bilateral=Blood deficiency. Unilateral (esp. first 3 fingers)=Internal Wind + Phlegm — possible impending Wind-stroke.

8 Q7-8 Chest, Abdomen, Limbs

CHEST PAIN?

Stabbing=HT-Blood stasis · w/ yellow sputum cough=Phlegm-Heat in LU · oppression=Phlegm obstructing LU or LR-Qi stagnation.

EPIGASTRIUM?

Dull+relieved by eating=Empty. Severe+worse w/ eating=Full. Stabbing=Heat/food retention/Phlegm-Fire/Blood stasis/LR invading ST. Fullness/heaviness=Dampness.

LOWER ABDOMEN?

Relieved by BM=Full · aggravated by BM=Empty · hypogastric pain=Damp-Heat Bladder.

LIMBS: TINGLING VS NUMBNESS?

Tingling=Blood def · numbness (often unilateral)=Wind or Wind-Phlegm · w/ pain=Qi/Blood stagnation.

TREMOR?

Always = Liver-Wind (Excess or Deficiency type).

9 Q11-12 Ears/Eyes, Cold/Heat/Fever

TINNITUS/DEAFNESS ONSET?

Sudden=Full (LR-Fire/Yang rising/Wind). Gradual=Empty (KD def). Worse w/ pressing ears=Full; relieved by pressing=Empty.

EYES?

Floaters=LR-Blood/Yin or KD-Yin def · photophobia=LR-Blood def or LR-Yang rising · dry eyes=LR/KD-Yin def.

COLD/HEAT PRESENTATION MAP?

Cold OR Heat alone=Interior. Simultaneous aversion-to-cold + fever=Exterior (Tai Yang/Wei level). Alternating cold/heat=Shao Yang (GB Heat, Qi level).

FEVER MECHANISM?

Reflects Zheng Qi vs pathogen struggle, not pathogen type: both strong=high fever, both weak=low fever, mismatched=medium.

HEAT/FEVER TIMING?

Afternoon/evening=Empty-Heat · constant low-grade=Damp-Heat · middle of night=Yin deficiency.

10 Q13-16 Emotional, Sexual, Women's, Children's

DEPRESSION EMPTY VS FULL?

Empty: SP/HT-Blood def, HT-Yang def, LR-Blood def, KD/HT-Yin def w/ Empty Heat. Full: LR-Qi stagnation → Heat → Phlegm → Phlegm-Fire harassing Mind (escalating severity).

IRRITABILITY/ANGER ROOTS?

Qi stagnation · Blood stasis · LR-Yang rising · Blood def · Yin def (± Empty-Heat) · Heat/Damp-Heat.

MEN: IMPOTENCE PATTERNS?

Cold+backache+clear urine=KD-Yang def · dizzy+palpitations+Choppy=HT-Blood def · rapid overflowing pulse=HT-Fire · scrotal heaviness+discharge=Damp-Heat LR channel.

WOMEN: MENSES TIMING PAIN?

Before period=Qi/Blood stagnation · during=Blood-Heat or stagnation of Cold · after=Blood deficiency.

MENSES COLOR/QUALITY?

Pale/bright red=Blood-Heat · pale=Blood def · purple/black+clots=Stasis of Blood/Cold · fresh red=Empty-Heat from Yin def.

MISCARRIAGE TIMING?

Before 3 months=Blood/Essence def · after 3 months=LR-Blood stasis or sinking of SP-Qi.

CHILDREN QUICK HITS?

Milk vomiting/colic=food retention · chronic cough+sticky sputum=Damp-Phlegm LU · skin rash+insomnia+character change=Latent Heat · chronic earache=Damp-Heat GB channel.